Table 1.5 Density of some common substances, at room temperature

S.No.	Nature	Materials	Density (kg/m^3)
1	Gas	Air	1.2
2	Liquid	Kerosene	800
3		Water	1,000
4		Mercury	13,600
5	Solid	Wood	770
6		Aluminium	2,700
7		Iron	7,800
8		Copper	8,900
9		Silver	10,500
10		Gold	19,300

The relationship between mass, density and volume are represented in the following density triangle.

- Density = Mass/ Volume
- Mass = Density × Volume
- Volume = Mass / Density

Problem 1.4

A solid cylinder of mass 280 kg has a volume of 4 m^3. Find the density of cylinder.

Solution

$$\text{Density of cylinder} = \frac{\text{Mass of cylinder}}{\text{Volume of cylinder}}$$

$$= \frac{280}{4} = 70\ kg/m^3$$

Problem 1.5

A box is made up of iron and it has a volume of 125 cm^3. Find its mass if the density of iron is 7.8 g / cm^3.

Solution

Density = Mass / Volume

Hence, Mass = Volume × Density

= 125 × 7.8 = 975 g.

Water has more density than oils like cooking oil and castor oil, although these oils appear to be denser than water. Density of castor oil is 961 kg/m3. If we put one drop of water in oil, water drop sinks. But, if we put one drop of oil in water, oil floats and forms a layer on water surface. However, some oils are denser than water.

Problem 1.6

A sphere is made from copper whose mass is 3000 kg. If the density of copper is 8900 kg/m, find the volume of the sphere.

Solution

Density = Mass / Volume

Hence, Volume = Mass / Density

= 3000 / 8900 = 30 / 89

= 0.34 m^3

1.5 Measuring larger distances

Normally, we use centimetre, metre and kilometre to express the distances that we measure in our day to day life. But, for space research, astronomers need to measure very long distances such as the distance between the earth and a star or the distance between two stars. To express these distances, we shall learn about two such units, namely,

i. Astronomical unit
ii. Light year

1.5.1 Astronomical Unit

We all know that the earth revolves around the sun in an elliptical orbit. Hence, the distance between the sun and the earth varies every day. When the earth is in its perihelion position (the position when the distance between the Earth and the Sun is short), the distance between

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